

VISIT · VICTR, VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY MEDICAL CENTER · 8 OCTOBER 2026

# Valuing the Hub Function

*Crediting support for other institutions' research*



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8 October 2026

# Where we stand

It shapes what we hope to learn.

## Hospital

**The University of Tokyo Hospital** is one of Japan's 16 Core Clinical Research Hospitals.  
The criteria I describe today apply to the center I run.

## National

**Representative Secretary, NUH-CRPI**  
The council of all national university hospitals: 42 universities, 44 hospitals.

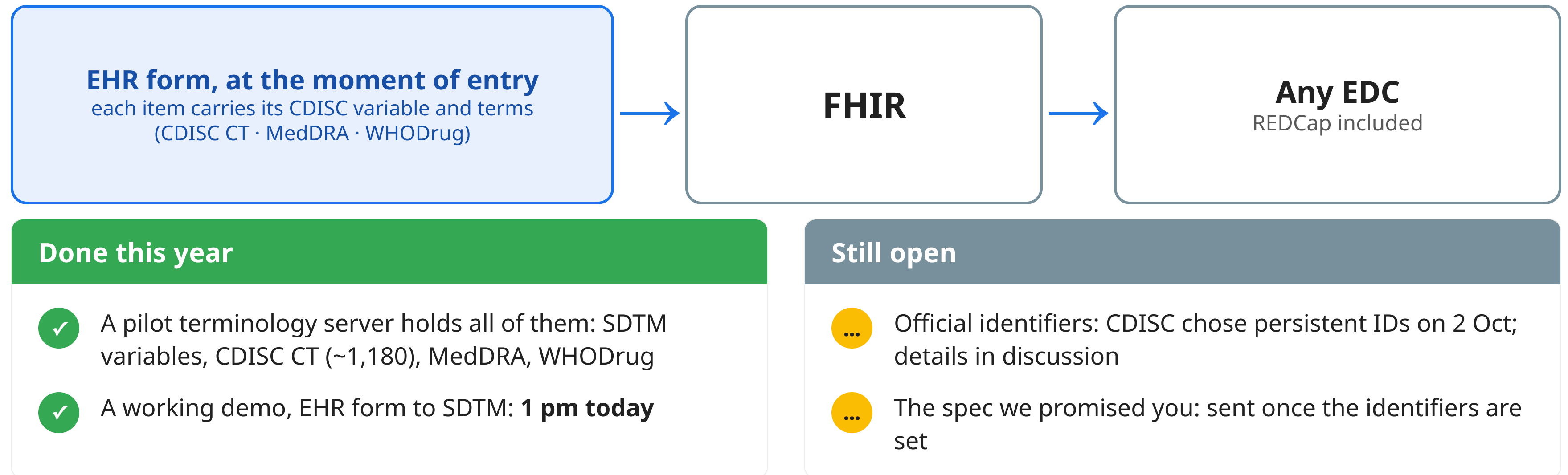
## Data

**Vice Chair, Japan CDISC Coordinating Committee · AMED principal investigator**  
Clinical data standards. This layer comes next.

Not one hospital's site visit: we came for a national system that is deciding how to measure its research hubs.

# A year on from our last visit

You asked whether our EDC would connect to the EHR. Our answer starts one step earlier.



# Japan's Core Clinical Research Hospitals

Created by law in 2015. The Minister approves hospitals that meet published criteria; 16 hold the designation today.

## CTSA award (US)

|                 |                             |
|-----------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>Nature</b>   | A grant                     |
| <b>Entry</b>    | Compete and win             |
| <b>Review</b>   | Periodic; the award can end |
| <b>Steering</b> | A national program office   |

## Core hospital (Japan)

|                 |                                        |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Nature</b>   | A legal status                         |
| <b>Entry</b>    | Meet the published criteria            |
| <b>Review</b>   | Kept until it fails the criteria       |
| <b>Steering</b> | No program office, no peer competition |

The criteria are the whole instrument, so what they count matters.

# What the criteria count

Three things, measured over the previous three years.

8

## **Trials**

Investigator-initiated trials for drug approval, or 4 of them plus 40 other trials

**In principle, led by the hospital's own investigator**

45

## **Papers**

Peer-reviewed English papers

**In principle, the first author is from the hospital**

15

## **Supports**

Studies supported at other institutions, per year. Mandatory, but a floor

**15 and 50 score the same**

A study led from outside counts only if the hospital's ARO takes on **the whole package**: protocol, data management and monitoring.

**The hub function is what the instrument measures least.**

# What happens as a result

What we see from inside the Core Hospitals: our observation, not yet a quantified study.

- ✕ **Small, easy-to-start trials.** Eight in three years is a hard number, and a small trial counts the same as a large one.
- ✕ **More papers.** Forty-five is a hard number too.
- ✕ **Support is penalized.** Every statistician, data manager and dollar moved to another institution's study is not spent on the hospital's own count.

The Ministry knows this. Its review this year keeps support as a floor, because the effort behind support varies too much to be scored.

That is exactly the problem your funders have had to solve.

# What we have learned so far

From NIH documents, Duke last Friday and Colorado yesterday.

## 1 Review, not counts

Reviewers judge coordination, data and dissemination, never in-house trials or first-author papers. Colorado: the annual report is read, not scored; the score comes at renewal.

## 2 Elsewhere the ARO sits outside the hub

Duke's DCRI and Colorado's CPC run apart from their CTSA hubs. Here, REDCap, the Trial Innovation Network and All of Us sit inside VICTR.

## 3 The base is level; institutions differ in support

Hub awards follow a tier set by NIH funding. Coordinating, data and statistical centers: about \$1.0B (¥160B) in FY2025, nearly twice the CTSA awards. Vanderbilt is second among academic institutions.

**Our proposal for Japan: credit the support a hub gives as its own achievement.**

# What we came to ask

Eight written questions: your agenda gives each one a session today.

|                                                               |                                                                                      |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                               |                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>8:10</div> <div>Community engagement</div> <div>Q8</div> | <div>8:40</div> <div>Coordinating Center</div> <div>Sean Collins</div> <div>Q3</div> | <div>10:00</div> <div>Metrics, money and shared infrastructure</div> <div>Paul Harris</div> <div>Q1Q2Q4Q6</div> | <div>11:00</div> <div>Research support workforce</div> <div>Terri Edwards</div> <div>Q5</div> | <div>11:30</div> <div>EHR data and BioVU</div> <div>Q7</div> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|

So let me go straight to what we most want to learn.

# What we most want to learn

Three questions for this morning with Paul.

**1**

## **The review itself**

What decided your last renewal, and what did it miss? Is your annual report, too, read but not scored?

**2**

## **Our question six**

If in-house trial and first-author counts decided hub status, could VICTR keep REDCap and the Trial Innovation Network open to others?

**3**

## **All of Us**

Your largest federal award is a national data center awarded outside ordinary peer review. How is it run, and what is it judged on, year to year?



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# Thank you



Now I would much rather hear from you.